

TorqFall — Direction Study v2 (standalone-event frame)

2026-09-04. Supersedes the framing of [[2 - TorqFall (direction study)]] (v1). Same two directions, re-decided under a new constraint from Yash: **each game is its own individual event, not merged into one day**. That single change dissolves v1's central tension and flips part of the recommendation.

What changed vs v1

v1 asked "which direction owns TorqFall's **slot** in the shared day, and does the other earn a second slot." Under the standalone-event frame there **is no shared slot** — each game is a whole event. Two knock-on effects:

1. **"No mid-event track reset" softens**. It existed only because other games needed the floor. A dedicated TorqFall event owns the floor all day → the gauntlet **can** reconfigure between rounds → **true Fall Guys round variety is back on the table** (v1 said it was impossible).
2. **Build-and-smash's fatal flaw (3–5 min rebuild) stops being fatal**. As its own event you **schedule** build/smash phases; the rebuild window becomes the audience **build phase**, not dead air.

So the call is no longer "pick one identity for one slot." It's **"both are viable standalone events — which do we run first, and how fun is each for beginners."**

Direction 1 — The Gauntlet (Fall Guys tournament)

Looks like: a show with an arc — Qualifiers → Semis → Grand Final, elimination bracket on a screen, one champion crowned. Floor is yours all day → run it in **phases that reconfigure the lane** (R1 obstacle race → R2 last-car-standing survival → Final gauntlet+finale). This is the properly-delivered Fall Guys fantasy the merged day couldn't give.

- **Beginner fun:** HIGH in-heat (chaos hides skill; everyone crashes). **Weakness — bigger now:** a paid ticket-holder eliminated in 60s stands around. **Fixable** with schedule room a one-game event has: **non-elimination qualifying** (N runs, accumulate points/place, never "out"), **respawn / loser's-bracket** heats, **free-play open laps** between rounds so knocked-out drivers keep driving.
- **Speed to run: FASTEST.** Rulebook ~90% done; obstacle kit cheap/soft/DIY (in [[Build & Fabrication Plan v1]]); physics known + safe. Lowest fabrication risk we have.
- **Content:** funnel pile-up, sweeper wipe-out, photo-finish, crowned champion. Proven.

Direction 2 — TorqSiege (Build & Smash)

Looks like: the best content in all of TorqWars — car through a wall, blocks flying, slow-mo collapse, Colosseum energy. As a standalone the format is a **Build → Siege → Rebuild loop**: teams get a creative

10–15 min build phase (foam / pre-scored cardboard), a timed siege phase (drivers attack), results, then reset while the next teams build. **The old rebuild-flaw becomes the participation hook** — a whole second (non-driving) way to play that families + mixed groups love.

- **Beginner fun: HIGHEST for the smash** — "drive at a wall = dopamine," zero skill floor, and critically **no failure state** (D1 can still bench a beginner; a smash cannot). Most beginner-friendly mechanic in the idea bank.
- **Gated on one hard unknown (unchanged from v1):** speed-limited rubber-tyred ~1 kg buggies hit **soft** → a stable tower won't collapse on camera. Must **engineer structures that collapse bigger than the hit** (loose-stacked light blocks, pre-scored cardboard, domino logic, weak-tab joints), and possibly allow a dedicated heavier **1/10 "siege ram" attacker** — which a standalone event permits (not bound to the shared speed-limited rental fleet). **Needs a physical collapse-test prototype before it can be graded or greenlit.**
- **Also:** burns materials every siege (recurring restock); lower throughput (fewer drivers/hr).
- **Speed to run: SLOWER** — R&D loop first, then fabrication + a materials model. Not the one to run first.

Recommendation — don't choose, sequence (two events)

	Event #1 — TorqFall (Gauntlet)	Event #2 — TorqSiege (Build & Smash)
Role	Ship first; learn ops on the low-risk one	The hero reel; prototype toward it
Readiness	~90% built	Gated on a collapse-physics test
Beginner fun	High (needs non-elim format tweak)	Highest (no failure state)
Content	Pile-ups, wipe-outs, crowned champion	Best single-shot reel we have
Cost/logistics	Cheap, DIY, low-risk	Material-hungry, R&D first
Run it	Now (venue+permit is the only clock)	Second , once physics land

Three moves:

1. **TorqFall gauntlet = Event #1.** Fastest to "we ran an event," and as a standalone it gets *better* (round variety + tournament arc). Learn marshalling, queue, filming, permits on the cheap one.
2. **TorqSiege = its own Event #2.** Earns its own name + day, exactly as the individual-event frame implies. Collapse-test in the calm after #1.
3. **De-risk #2 with #1 as a live lab:** seed a **breakable wall as the TorqFall finish gate** — gives every TorqFall player the smash payoff *and* field-tests the collapse mechanic cheaply before committing to a full TorqSiege build. (This is v1's "smashable finish" graft, now doing double duty as R&D for Event #2.)

How fast: for both, the build side is weeks; the real clock is **venue lock + the 15–21 day police lead**, not fabrication. TorqFall runs fastest because there is nothing to prototype.

Next if approved: (a) build a full **Event #1 (TorqFall standalone) run-of-show** — phase schedule, non-elim qualifying format, ops/marshal plan, needs list + timeline; (b) open a **TorqSiege concept card**

+ spec the collapse-test in [[Build & Fabrication Plan v1]]; (c) fold the non-elim format + smashable finish into [[2 - TorqFall (rulebook)]].